



Sage Whitlock

FAMILY SOLICITOR

“Has drawn up every will in Fernley, and keeps every secret neatly filed.”



✦ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ✦

CORE CHARACTER

ALWAYS IN PLAY

WHAT TO WEAR

A pinstriped suit or a smart dark dress, spectacles on a chain, and a leather document case tucked under one arm.

At the table you are: polished, reassuring and always ready with a precise answer.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

Printed single-sided, so later rounds can't show through.



THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

Never show this booklet to anyone. You may bend the truth about your secret, but never about the evidence.



You are the culprit.

Nobody must find out. Read every word of this page carefully.

What really happened

You are the sole trustee of the Thistle Trust. Over three years you quietly “borrowed” £4,000 from it to cover bad investments. At 5:15 tonight Barty told you the gap had been found and that everything would go to a London firm on Monday.

WHAT YOU DID

At about six, while Barty was out in the garden, you slipped into the study, stirred two sachets of your own Dormital sleeping powder into the waiting glass and dropped the papers into the fire. You tucked a note under the saucer so that, if anyone walked in, you were “only leaving Barty a note.” Then you went up to the Blue Room and came down at 6:30.

YOUR COVER STORY

After the meeting ended at 5:35 you left a friendly note on the desk, then sat in the library with your papers until the sherry at 6:30.

Where you were (the truth)

5:15 - 5:35	Meeting with Barty in the study.
5:35 - 6:00	Up in the Blue Room (you will say: the library).
about 6:00 - 6:08	In the study, alone with the glass.
6:08 - 6:30	Back upstairs, then down to the sherry.

Your goal tonight

Keep suspicion on the others: Rowan (the torn check), Ellis (Dormital is the doctor’s medicine) and Morgan (who poured the glass). You may lie about yourself, but never deny what an evidence card says. Stay unsuspected to win Best Performance.

If someone asks you...

“Do you take sleeping powder?” “Now and then, for my nerves. Half of Fernley does.”
 “What was the meeting about?” “The quarterly statement for the Trust. All in order, as you will see.”
 “Where were you at six?” “In the library, with my papers and the quiet.”

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

Sage Whitlock • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS • Barty asked me down to go over the Thistle Trust's quarterly statement. I brought it in that envelope (Evidence #3). All perfectly in order.

- Rowan was very keen to see Barty alone straight after me. I would ask why.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “Who inherits Thistledown House now?”

- **Morgan:** “Who poured Barty’s glass tonight, and who handled the bottle?”

YOUR TASK

Steer the talk to Evidence #1 and wonder aloud who could have walked into the study.



 FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS • Yes, the green-ink note is mine. Say you left it as you came out of your meeting, at about twenty to six.

- Remind everyone that Dormital is Dr. Fairweather's prescription. Who knows what is in that doctor's bag?

ASK

- **Ellis:** “Who in Fernley do you prescribe Dormital to?”

- **Rowan:** “That torn check. How much did you ask Barty for?”

YOUR TASK

Keep the table talking about money troubles: bring up Evidence #6 at least twice.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

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THEN VOTE

Round 3 • Dessert

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- If the box in the Blue Room comes up, insist it sat open on the washstand where anyone could reach it.
- Barty worried about money all the time. Nobody should read anything into an old client's grumbling.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “You had the bottle and the glass in your hands. Why should we believe you?”
- **Ellis:** “You were angry with Barty this evening. About what?”

YOUR TASK

Before the vote, cast calm, reasonable doubt on one other suspect.

NOTES

SUSPECTS AT A GLANCE (PUBLIC INFORMATION)

#	NAME	ROLE	#	NAME	ROLE
10	Rowan Thistle	Heir to Thistledown House	14	Harper Vale	Food Critic
11	Ellis Fairweather	Family Doctor	15	Quinn Ashby	Head Gardener
12	Morgan Pike	Steward of Thistledown House	16	Avery Lark	Newspaper Reporter
13	Sage Whitlock	Family Solicitor	17	Jules Marchetti	Visiting Chef